



STEADY MEN 16:13

SUMMER COMMITMENT & GROUP RHYTHM

A daily walk in the Word. Honest brotherhood. A stronger faith.

BIG IDEA

This is a summer commitment for men who want to become more faithful husbands, fathers, leaders, friends, and most importantly, men of God.

It is also a community of men committed to advocating for one another, keeping each other accountable, and pushing one another toward a stronger and more active faith. Together, we will pursue daily time in God's Word, hold honest conversation, consistent prayer, and the kind of brotherhood that helps men grow instead of trying to walk alone.

WHAT THIS GROUP IS ABOUT

Not a group to watch from the sidelines

Steady Men 16:13 is a commitment to daily time in God's Word, honest reflection, intentional brotherhood, and real growth. None of us will do this perfectly. Life will get busy. Work schedules, family responsibilities, sickness, travel, and unexpected situations will happen. Missing a day does not mean you have failed. But the overall expectation is clear: we are showing up, staying engaged, and helping one another keep moving forward.

We will challenge one another, encourage one another, pray for one another, and hold one another accountable with grace and honesty.

We will pursue one another, ask honest questions, and refuse to let each other quietly disappear. We will keep each other accountable to being active, engaged, and part of the group, not to shame anyone, but because growth happens when men are known, supported, and challenged.

"And let us consider how we may spur one another on toward love and good deeds, not giving up meeting together, as some are in the habit of doing, but encouraging one another."

— Hebrews 10:24-25

THE SUMMER RHYTHM

A simple pattern of steady growth

The rhythm is simple on purpose. Daily Scripture keeps us rooted. Prayer keeps us connected. The sermon series gives us direction. Gathering together gives us a place to be known, encouraged, and challenged.

Daily Scripture Reading

Every day, there will be a planned Bible reading. This is the core rhythm of the group: men opening God’s Word daily and allowing it to shape how we live.

A reminder of the day’s reading will be posted in the WhatsApp group. Once you have completed it, a simple checkmark, heart, or “done” is enough to show that you are staying engaged.

When something stands out, convicts you, encourages you, raises a question, or connects to your life, share it with the group. Expand on it when needed so others can hear what God may be showing you as well.

The goal is not to sound impressive. The goal is to be in God’s Word and let it shape us.

Prayer for One Another

Each man will intentionally pray for another man in the group each day.

This may be a quiet prayer as you go through your day, or it may come through a conversation, text, or call. Reach out when you need prayer, encouragement, wisdom, or accountability. Share specific struggles when appropriate, and do not be afraid to share praise when God is doing something good.

The goal is that we would intentionally think about one another, care for one another, and regularly bring each other before God in prayer.

Biweekly Gatherings and Study Preparation

Every two weeks, we will gather together as men for intentional time around God’s Word and one another. This may be over breakfast, lunch, dinner, coffee, or simply time set aside to be together. (See dates in table below)

In preparation for each gathering, there will be an assigned message from Joby Martin’s *Stand Firm and Act Like Men* series, along with a summary and study guide. Each man is expected to watch the message, read through the material, reflect honestly, and come prepared to participate in the discussion.

These gatherings are meant to be a place where men can open up honestly, encourage one another, grow together, and keep each other accountable. The study guide is there to help start meaningful conversation, not to rush through a checklist. Come ready for honest discussion, practical reflection, and encouragement from other men who are pursuing the same goal.

GATHERING DATES

Friday JULY 17	Friday JULY 31	Friday AUGUST 14	Friday AUGUST 28
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HOW OUR GATHERINGS FLOW

OPENING PRAYER	HONEST DISCUSSION	PERSONAL REFLECTION	PRACTICAL ACTION	PRAYER FOR ONE ANOTHER
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The study guide is not meant to be rushed through or treated like homework. It is there to help us start real conversations and become more open and honest with one another. Who knows we may not talk about any of the questions, it will all depend where our community and conversation brings us.



Throughout the summer, we will memorize Psalm 1:1–3 together.

This passage gives us a clear picture of the kind of men we want to become: men who do not drift with the world, but delight in God’s Word and build their lives around it. As we stay rooted in Scripture, God grows steadiness, strength, and fruitfulness in us over time.

This is not a test, and we will not be reciting it together at each gathering. It is a personal commitment to hide God’s Word in our hearts. Men who are rooted in Scripture are better prepared to stand firm in temptation, lead their homes with wisdom, protect the people God has entrusted to them, and remain steady when life becomes difficult.

God is faithful to strengthen and provide for the men who seek Him. The goal is not simply to know more verses, but to have God’s Word ready in us when we need truth, direction, courage, and faith.

“Blessed is the one who does not walk in step with the wicked or stand in the way that sinners take or sit in the company of mockers, but whose delight is in the law of the Lord, and who meditates on his law day and night. That person is like a tree planted by streams of water, which yields its fruit in season and whose leaf does not wither – whatever they do prospers. .”

— Psalm 1:1-3

OUR COMMITMENT

I am choosing to pursue God intentionally this summer.

- Spend time in God’s Word each day through the assigned reading.
- Check in and participate in the WhatsApp group consistently.
- Share honestly when God is teaching, convicting, or challenging me.
- Pray specifically for another man in the group each day.
- Watch the assigned sermon and work through the study material.
- Make every reasonable effort to attend the biweekly gatherings.
- Be honest when I am struggling instead of withdrawing or pretending.
- Receive correction, encouragement, and accountability with humility.
- Stay engaged with the group and receive honest follow up when I begin to pull back or disappear.
- Help create a group where men can speak honestly and grow without fear of being torn down.
- Pursue becoming a better husband, father, leader, and man of God.

I understand that this is not about perfection. It is about faithful participation, steady growth, and refusing to walk alone.

“As iron sharpens iron, so one person sharpens another.”

— Proverbs 27:17

MY COMMITMENT

Name: _____

Signature: _____

Date: _____



STEADY MEN 16:13

ROOTED IN THE WORD

SUMMER READING PLAN | JULY 5 – SEPTEMBER 5, 2026

THE DAILY RHYTHM

Read the New Testament passage first, then the wisdom or Old Testament companion reading. Each day is built to give roughly 10–15 minutes in God's Word. Read steadily, not hurriedly.

UPCOMING GATHERINGS

Friday July 17	Friday July 31	Friday August 14	Friday August 28
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MEN'S GATHERINGS — details will be shared in the WhatsApp group.

WEEK 1 | July 5–July 11

DATE	NEW TESTAMENT	WISDOM + OLD TESTAMENT
Sunday July 5	Luke 1	Proverbs 1–2
Monday July 6	Luke 2	Proverbs 3
Tuesday July 7	Luke 3	Proverbs 4–5
Wednesday July 8	Luke 4	Psalms 27; Proverbs 6:1–19
Thursday July 9	Luke 5	Psalms 23; Proverbs 6:20–35
Friday July 10	1 Corinthians 16:13–14 ANCHOR READING	Joshua 1:1–9; Proverbs 3:1–12
Saturday July 11	Luke 6	Proverbs 7–8

**WEEK 2 | July 12–July 18**

DATE	NEW TESTAMENT	WISDOM + OLD TESTAMENT
Sunday July 12	Luke 7	Psalms 34:1–10; Proverbs 9
Monday July 13	Luke 8	Proverbs 10:1–16
Tuesday July 14	Luke 9	Proverbs 10:17–32; Psalm 15
Wednesday July 15	Luke 10	Proverbs 11:1–15
Thursday July 16	John 15:1–11 ANCHOR READING	Psalms 92:12–15; Proverbs 3:13–26
Friday July 17	Luke 11	Psalms 37:1–11; Proverbs 11:16–31 MEN'S GATHERING TODAY — details shared in WhatsApp.
Saturday July 18	Luke 12	Proverbs 12:1–14

WEEK 3 | July 19–July 25

DATE	NEW TESTAMENT	WISDOM + OLD TESTAMENT
Sunday July 19	Luke 13	Proverbs 12:15–28; Psalm 19:1–6
Monday July 20	Luke 14	Proverbs 13:1–14
Tuesday July 21	Luke 15	Proverbs 13:15–25; Psalm 32
Wednesday July 22	Luke 16	Proverbs 14:1–16
Thursday July 23	Ephesians 6:10–18 ANCHOR READING	Psalms 144:1–2; Proverbs 4:20–27
Friday July 24	Luke 17	Proverbs 14:17–35; Psalm 46
Saturday July 25	Luke 18	Proverbs 15:1–17

**WEEK 4 | July 26–August 1**

DATE	NEW TESTAMENT	WISDOM + OLD TESTAMENT
Sunday July 26	Luke 19	Proverbs 15:18–33; Psalm 51:1–12
Monday July 27	Luke 20	Proverbs 16:10–25
Tuesday July 28	Luke 21	Proverbs 16:26–33; Psalm 63:1–8
Wednesday July 29	James 1:19–27 ANCHOR READING	Proverbs 4:1–19; Psalm 19:7–14
Thursday July 30	Luke 22	Proverbs 17:1–14
Friday July 31	Luke 23	Proverbs 17:15–28; Psalm 84:1–5 MEN'S GATHERING TODAY — details shared in WhatsApp.
Saturday August 1	Luke 24	Proverbs 18:1–15

WEEK 5 | August 2–August 8

DATE	NEW TESTAMENT	WISDOM + OLD TESTAMENT
Sunday August 2	Acts 1	Proverbs 18:16–24; Psalm 90:12–17
Monday August 3	Philippians 2:1–11 ANCHOR READING	Ecclesiastes 4:9–12; Micah 6:6–8
Tuesday August 4	Acts 2	Proverbs 19:1–15
Wednesday August 5	Acts 3	Proverbs 19:16–29; Psalm 91:1–8
Thursday August 6	Acts 4	Proverbs 20:1–15
Friday August 7	Acts 5	Proverbs 20:16–30; Psalm 103:1–12
Saturday August 8	Acts 6	Proverbs 21:1–16

**WEEK 6 | August 9–August 15**

DATE	NEW TESTAMENT	WISDOM + OLD TESTAMENT
Sunday August 9	1 Peter 5:5–11 ANCHOR READING	Isaiah 40:28–31; Proverbs 16:1–9
Monday August 10	Acts 7	Proverbs 21:17–31; Psalm 112
Tuesday August 11	Acts 8	Proverbs 22:1–16
Wednesday August 12	Acts 9	Proverbs 22:17–29; Psalm 121
Thursday August 13	Acts 10	Proverbs 23:1–18
Friday August 14	Acts 11	Proverbs 23:19–35; Psalm 127 MEN'S GATHERING TODAY — details shared in WhatsApp.
Saturday August 15	Romans 12:9–21 ANCHOR READING	Psalm 15; Proverbs 11:24–30

WEEK 7 | August 16–August 22

DATE	NEW TESTAMENT	WISDOM + OLD TESTAMENT
Sunday August 16	Acts 12	Proverbs 24:1–16
Monday August 17	Acts 13	Proverbs 24:17–34; Psalm 128
Tuesday August 18	Acts 14	Proverbs 25:1–14
Wednesday August 19	Acts 15	Proverbs 25:15–28; Psalm 141
Thursday August 20	Acts 16	Proverbs 26:1–16
Friday August 21	2 Timothy 2:1–7 ANCHOR READING	Proverbs 27:5–17; Ecclesiastes 4:9–12
Saturday August 22	Acts 17	Proverbs 26:17–28; Psalm 145:1–13

**WEEK 8 | August 23–August 29**

DATE	NEW TESTAMENT	WISDOM + OLD TESTAMENT
Sunday August 23	Acts 18	Ecclesiastes 1
Monday August 24	Acts 19	Ecclesiastes 2:1–17; Psalm 39:4–7
Tuesday August 25	Acts 20	Ecclesiastes 2:18–26; Psalm 127:1–2
Wednesday August 26	Acts 21	Ecclesiastes 3:1–15
Thursday August 27	Galatians 5:16–26 ANCHOR READING	Psalm 139:23–24; Proverbs 25:28; Proverbs 4:23
Friday August 28	Acts 22	Ecclesiastes 3:16–22; Psalm 16 MEN'S GATHERING TODAY — details shared in WhatsApp.
Saturday August 29	Acts 23	Ecclesiastes 4:1–8; Psalm 73:23–28

WEEK 9 | August 30–September 5

DATE	NEW TESTAMENT	WISDOM + OLD TESTAMENT
Sunday August 30	Acts 24	Ecclesiastes 5:1–20
Monday August 31	Acts 25	Ecclesiastes 6; Psalm 49:5–20
Tuesday September 1	Acts 26	Job 1:1–12; Psalm 46
Wednesday September 2	Hebrews 12:1–3 ANCHOR READING	Isaiah 35:3–10; Proverbs 24:10–16
Thursday September 3	Acts 27	Job 1:13–22; Psalm 34:17–22
Friday September 4	Acts 28	Job 2:1–10; Psalm 62:5–8
Saturday September 5	Colossians 3:12–17 ANCHOR READING	Psalm 133; Ecclesiastes 4:9–12; Proverbs 17:17

STEADY MEN 16:13

WHERE HAVE ALL THE GOOD MEN GONE? WK 1

Sermon summary

Primary text: Genesis 1:26-27; Genesis 2:5-25; Genesis 3:1-21



BIG IDEA

Good manhood is not cultural bravado or self-reliance. It is a God-given calling lived under the authority of Jesus: men who work faithfully, obey God, love sacrificially, and lead with humble responsibility.

KEY SCRIPTURES

Biblical Foundation

- 1 Corinthians 16:13-14 - Be watchful, stand firm in the faith, be strong, and let everything be done in love.
- Genesis 1:26-27 - God created humanity in His image, male and female.
- Genesis 2:7, 15-18 - God formed man, gave him work to enjoy, a will to obey, and a woman to love.
- Genesis 3:1-21 - Sin brought passivity, blame, shame, broken relationships, and cursed work.
- 2 Peter 1:3 - God's divine power gives believers what they need for life and godliness.

THE SERMON'S MAIN MESSAGE

What Biblical Manhood Is Built On

1

Created on Purpose

Manhood is God's idea, not a set of hobbies, appearance, aggression, or cultural stereotypes. A biblical man is called to image God through courage, responsibility, strength under control, and love. The sermon names the calling as prophet, priest, servant, king, provider, and protector.

KEY SCRIPTURES: Genesis 1:26-27; 1 Corinthians 16:13-14

2

Formed for Relationship with God

Adam was formed from dust, but he became fully alive when God breathed life into him. A man cannot become who God calls him to be by external strength alone; he needs the life and leadership of God.

KEY SCRIPTURES: Genesis 2:7; John 15:5

3

Given Work to Enjoy

Work existed before the fall. Men are called to cultivate, build, provide, serve, and use their gifts for the flourishing of others. Comfort and passivity are poor substitutes for meaningful responsibility.

KEY SCRIPTURES: Genesis 2:15; 1 Timothy 5:8; Colossians 3:23

4

Given a Will to Obey

God gave Adam freedom and a clear command. Real freedom is not doing whatever we want; it is trusting that God is good and that His ways lead to life. Sin begins when we distrust His word, work, or worth.

KEY SCRIPTURES: Genesis 2:16-17; Genesis 3:1-6; Psalm 119:9-11

5

Called to Love and Take Responsibility

God said it was not good for man to be alone, and He gave woman as a helper. Sin distorted this relationship through passivity, blame, control, and shame. A godly man does not hide or blame; he takes responsibility, pursues reconciliation, and loves sacrificially.

KEY SCRIPTURES: Genesis 2:18-25; Genesis 3:9-12; Ephesians 5:25-28

THE GOSPEL HOPE

Manhood Begins on Your Knees

BEND THE KNEE

The answer is not “try harder” or “man up” through willpower. The beginning of godly manhood is surrender to Jesus. God covers shame, forgives sin, and gives His Spirit to strengthen men for the calling He has given them.

PUT IT INTO PRACTICE

The Response

STAND FIRM

- Ask where you have been passive, defensive, or self-reliant.
- Bring one area of disobedience or shame honestly to Jesus.
- Choose one responsibility at home, work, or church that needs your attention.

STAND TOGETHER

- Encourage another man instead of competing with him.
- Pursue your wife, children, family, or close relationships intentionally.
- Build accountability before a crisis forces you to seek it.

STEADY MEN 16:13

WHERE HAVE ALL THE GOOD MEN GONE?

Men's group study guide

Primary text: Genesis 1:26-27; Genesis 2:5-25; Genesis 3:1-21



BIG IDEA

A godly man is formed by God, surrendered to Christ, faithful in work, obedient to God, responsible in relationships, and strengthened through grace and brotherhood.

READ TOGETHER

Genesis 2:7, 15-18, 21-25; Genesis 3:1-12; 1 Corinthians 16:13-14.

START WITH HONESTY

Discussion

1. What part of the sermon's definition of a godly man stood out to you most, and why?
 - A biblical man is called to image God through courage, responsibility, strength under control, and love. The sermon names the calling as prophet, priest, servant, king, provider, and protector.
2. Where do you see the difference between biblical strength and the cultural extremes of passivity or aggression?
3. The sermon says men were given work to enjoy, a will to obey, and a woman to love. Which of those areas feels strongest or weakest in your life right now?
4. Adam was present but passive, then hid and blamed after sin. Where are you most tempted to avoid responsibility, hide, or blame?
5. What does it look like for you to "bend the knee to Jesus" instead of trying to become a better man through sheer willpower?
6. Who is one person God may be calling you to love, pursue, encourage, or protect more faithfully this week?

PERSONAL REFLECTION

- Where am I relying on myself rather than God?
- Where have I become passive or avoided responsibility?

THIS WEEK'S STEP

- Take one responsibility you have been delaying.
- Text one brother and ask for prayer and accountability.

CLOSING PRAYER

Pray Together

Father, we confess that we do not have what it takes in ourselves. Form us into men who are humble, faithful, courageous, responsible, and full of love. Help us trust Your word, obey Your call, lead through service, and receive strength from Jesus Christ. Amen.

STEADY MEN 16:13

STAND FIRM & ACT LIKE MEN

Sermon summary | Primary text: 1 Peter 5:6-10



BIG IDEA

A steady man is not self-sufficient or perfect. He stays alert, humbles himself before God, brings his burdens to Christ, refuses isolation, takes sin seriously, and gets back up through grace.

KEY SCRIPTURES

Biblical Foundation

- 1 Corinthians 16:13-14 - Be watchful, stand firm in the faith, be strong, and let everything be done in love.
- 1 Peter 5:6-10 - Humble yourselves, cast your anxieties on God, be watchful, resist the devil, and trust God to restore and strengthen you.
- Philippians 4:6-7 - Bring anxiety to God in prayer, with thanksgiving, and receive His guarding peace.
- 1 Corinthians 6:18 - Flee sexual immorality rather than trying to manage temptation near its edge.

THE SERMON'S MAIN WARNING

Five Ways Men Get Pulled Off the Wall

1

Pride

Pride makes a man self-focused, defensive, and dependent on recognition. It keeps him from confession, worship, correction, and surrender. The answer is not pretending to be small; it is willingly placing himself under the mighty hand of God.

KEY SCRIPTURES: 1 Peter 5:6; Romans 12:3; James 4:6-10

2

Worry and Anxiety

Responsibility becomes anxiety when a man begins to believe everything depends on him. Worry is misplaced faith. God invites men to throw their burdens onto Him through prayer instead of repeatedly carrying them alone.

KEY SCRIPTURES: 1 Peter 5:7; Philippians 4:6-7; Matthew 6:25-34

3

Laziness and Abdication

Comfort, distraction, and passivity pull men away from their calling. Faithful manhood requires presence at home, service in the church, discipline in daily life, and a willingness to do hard things rather than live for comfort.

KEY SCRIPTURES: 1 Peter 5:8; Luke 9:23; Genesis 2:15; 2 Samuel 11:1

4

Isolation

The isolated man is vulnerable. Christian brotherhood is not optional background support; it is part of how God strengthens men. Men need brothers who know them, pray for them, challenge them, and help carry them when they are weak.

KEY SCRIPTURES: 1 Peter 5:8-9; Ecclesiastes 4:9-12; Hebrews 10:24-25; Matthew 26:36-46

5

Lust and Sexual Sin

Sexual temptation is not something to test or negotiate with. Scripture calls men to flee. Freedom requires confession, practical guardrails, honest accountability, and a growing love for Christ that makes lesser loves lose their grip.

KEY SCRIPTURES: 1 Corinthians 6:18; Proverbs 6:27-28; Matthew 5:27-30

THE GOSPEL HOPE**Grace for the Man Who Has Fallen****FAILURE IS NOT FINAL**

1 Peter 5:10 says that the God of all grace will Himself restore, confirm, strengthen, and establish His people. Men do not fight for God's acceptance. In Christ, they fight from the security of being forgiven, called, and loved.

PUT IT INTO PRACTICE**The Response****STAND FIRM**

- Humble yourself before God.
- Cast anxiety onto Him in prayer.
- Wake up to areas of passivity and distraction.

STAND TOGETHER

- Bring your struggle into Christian brotherhood.
- Flee sexual temptation early and decisively.
- Receive grace, then get back on the wall.

Bottom line: Steady men do not deny weakness. They bring it into the light, stand firm in faith, and keep returning to the grace and strength of Jesus Christ.

STEADY MEN 16:13

STAND FIRM & ACT LIKE MEN

Men's group study guide | 1 Peter 5:6-10



BIG IDEA

A strong Christian man is humble before God, alert to spiritual danger, honest about weakness, connected to brotherhood, and steady because Christ strengthens him.

READ TOGETHER

1 Peter 5:6-10, then 1 Corinthians 16:13-14.

START WITH HONESTY

Discussion

1. What stands out most to you from 1 Peter 5:6-10? Why?
2. Of the five dangers discussed - pride, anxiety, passivity, isolation, and lust - which is most likely to pull you off course right now?
3. Where are you tempted to rely on yourself instead of humbling yourself under God's hand?
4. What burden do you need to cast on God rather than continuing to carry alone?
5. Who are the men who know what is really going on in your life and are praying for you?
6. What is one guardrail or decisive action that would help you flee temptation earlier?

PERSONAL REFLECTION

- Where do I need to humble myself?
- What do I need to hand over to God?
- Who do I need to invite into greater honesty?

THIS WEEK'S STEP

- Pray out loud with your wife, children, or another man.
- Contact one brother and ask how you can pray for him.
- Remove one distraction or temptation that is pulling you away from faithfulness.

CLOSING PRAYER

- Father, make us watchful, humble, strong in faith, and full of love. Help us reject pride, fear, passivity, isolation, and sin. Restore us where we have fallen and help us stand firm together in Christ. Amen.

STEADY MEN 16:13

STAND FIRM

Sermon summary | Week 3 | Primary text: Ephesians 6:10-18



BIG IDEA

Standing firm is not aggressive self-reliance. It is standing in the Lord's strength, recognizing the real enemy, and fighting for the faith, peace, and protection of the people God has entrusted to us.

THE SERMON'S MAIN CALL

Fight for Your People, Not Against Them

The real battle is not against flesh and blood. A steady man refuses to turn his wife, children, brothers, or coworkers into enemies. He puts on God's armor and stands in Christ's victory for their good.

KEY SCRIPTURES

Biblical Foundation

- 1 Corinthians 16:13-14 - Be watchful, stand firm, be strong, and act in love.
- Ephesians 6:10-18 - Be strong in the Lord, take up His armor, and pray at all times.
- 1 Samuel 17:45-47 - The battle belongs to the Lord, not human strength.

HOW WE STAND FIRM

The Armor of God for the Life of a Man

TRUTH Belt of Truth Make Jesus and His Word the center of the home. Replace the lies coming through culture and screens with what God says is true. KEY: Eph. 6:14; John 14:6	IDENTITY Breastplate of Righteousness Live from Christ-given identity, not performance. Speak that identity over those you love and guard their hearts from lies. KEY: Eph. 6:14; 2 Cor. 5:21; Prov. 4:23
PEACE Shoes of the Gospel of Peace Bring the peace of Christ into rooms. Lead by honest confession, repentance, and reconciliation rather than control. KEY: Eph. 6:15; Col. 3:15	FAITH Shield of Faith Link shields with other believers. Build a faith that can cover a brother or family member when they are weak. KEY: Eph. 6:16; Mark 2:1-12
GOSPEL Helmet of Salvation Keep eternity in view. Help your family know the gospel and the saving work of Christ, not merely succeed in this life. KEY: Eph. 6:17; Rom. 10:9-10	WORD + PRAYER Sword of the Spirit Learn, pray, and use Scripture against lies. Prayer is active dependence on God and a real part of the battle. KEY: Eph. 6:17-18; Matt. 4:1-11

THE RESPONSE

FIGHT FOR YOUR PEOPLE • Pray aloud over your wife, children, or a brother. • Speak one biblical truth over someone this week.	STAND IN CHRIST • Choose one "it is written" verse for a present battle. • Remember: the battle is the Lord's, and victory is in Jesus.
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STEADY MEN 16:13

STAND FIRM

Men's group study guide | Week 3 | Ephesians 6:10-18



BIG IDEA

Standing firm is not about trying to become tougher on our own. It means depending on Christ, recognizing that people are not the enemy, and putting on the armor God has provided so we can fight for the people we love.

READ TOGETHER

Ephesians 6:10-18, then 1 Corinthians 16:13-14

START WITH HONESTY

Discussion

1. What stood out most to you from Ephesians 6:10-18 or from this sermon? Why?
2. How does it change the way you handle conflict when you remember that your battle is not against flesh and blood?
3. Where are you most tempted to fight with someone you should instead be fighting for?
4. Which part of the armor feels most needed in your life right now: truth, identity, peace, faith, salvation, Scripture, or prayer?
5. What lie has been gaining ground in your mind or your home? What truth from Scripture directly answers it?
6. When you walk into a room, particularly at home, does your presence usually bring peace or tension? What honest feedback might your family give?
7. Who in your life needs you to offer "shield of faith" coverage right now through encouragement, prayer, or practical help?
8. What Scripture can become an "it is written" response to a current temptation, fear, anger, or discouragement?

PERSONAL REFLECTION

- What false message do I need to replace with biblical truth?
- Where do I need to lead with repentance or reconciliation?
- Who has God placed under my care right now?

THIS WEEK'S STEP

- Pray Ephesians 6:10-18 over your home on three separate days.
- Memorize one verse for a current battle.
- Reach out to one brother and ask how you can cover him in prayer.

CLOSING PRAYER

Father, make us strong in Your strength, not our own. Help us put on Your armor, recognize the real enemy, and fight for the people You have entrusted to us. Fill our homes with truth, peace, faith, Scripture, and prayer. Keep us alert, united, and firm in Christ. Amen.

STEADY MEN 16:13

BE STRONG

Sermon summary | Week 4 | Primary text: Matthew 20:17-28



BIG IDEA

Biblical strength is not position, possession, or power. It is a life ordered under Jesus, able to endure hardship, be humble under authority, and willing to serve others in love.

THE SERMON'S MAIN CALL

Use Your Strength for Others

Jesus redefines greatness. He did not grasp for power; He submitted to the Father, went to the cross, and gave His life as a ransom. A steady man receives his strength from Christ and uses it for the good of those entrusted to him.

KEY SCRIPTURES

Biblical Foundation

- 1 Corinthians 16:13-14 - Be strong, stand firm, and let all you do be done in love.
- Matthew 20:17-28 - Greatness in Christ is found in serving, not being served.
- John 13:1-17 - Jesus uses His authority to wash His disciples' feet.

WHAT STRENGTH LOOKS LIKE

Strength Redefined by Jesus is:

RHYTHM A Sabbath Man Put Jesus before productivity. Rest is not escape or laziness; it reorders a man's life around God so he can love and lead from a full place. KEY: Gen. 2:2-3; Ex. 20:8-11; Mark 2:27	ENDURANCE A Persevering Man Take responsibility and endure hardship for the good of others. He does not quit, blame-shift, or escape when faithfulness costs him. KEY: Matt. 20:22; Gal. 6:9; Prov. 24:16
HUMILITY A Humble Man Trust God's authority and make much of Jesus, not yourself. Real strength does not grasp for position or personal recognition. KEY: Matt. 20:23; John 3:30; Phil. 2:3-8	SERVICE A Serving Man Use your influence and strength to carry burdens, meet needs, and serve at home when no one is applauding. KEY: Matt. 20:26-28; John 13:12-17; Eph. 5:25

THE RESPONSE

ORDER YOUR LIFE • Identify one pace or commitment keeping Jesus and your people from receiving your best. • Set one concrete Sabbath rhythm for the next two weeks.	SERVE ON PURPOSE • Take on one unseen responsibility at home this week without announcement or keeping score. • Ask: Where can I take responsibility and serve, even when it costs me?
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STEADY MEN 16:13

BE STRONG

Men's group study guide | Week 4 | Matthew 20:17-28



BIG IDEA

True strength is not position, possession, power, or pretending to have it all together. It is a life rightly ordered under Jesus: resting in Him, enduring hardship for others, walking humbly, and serving in love.

READ TOGETHER

Matthew 20:17-28, then John 13:1-17 and 1 Corinthians 16:13-14

START WITH HONESTY

Discussion

1. What stood out most to you from Matthew 20:17-28 or from this sermon? Why?
2. How does Jesus redefine greatness and strength in this passage? Where have you been tempted to accept the world's definition instead?
3. Where has busyness crowded out time with God or the people you are called to love? What would it look like to put Jesus first in your rhythm this week?
4. What hard responsibility, pain, or conversation are you most tempted to avoid right now? What would perseverance look like?
5. Where do pride, self-promotion, or the need to be right show up most clearly in your life? What would humility look like there?
6. How do you usually respond when someone else has authority over you or when you do not get your way? What does Jesus model?
7. What is a "lowest role" or unnoticed act of service in your home, work, or church that you could take on willingly this week?
8. Ten years from now, what kind of man do you want your wife, children, friends, or coworkers to say you were? What needs to change now to move in that direction?

PERSONAL REFLECTION

- Where do I need to put Jesus back in first place?
- What responsibility or hard conversation am I avoiding?
- Who can I serve this week without needing recognition?

THIS WEEK'S STEP

- Set aside intentional time this week to rest, worship, and reconnect with God and your family.
- Take responsibility for one hard thing you have been avoiding.
- Serve someone in a practical, unasked, and unseen way.

CLOSING PRAYER

Father, make us strong in the way Jesus is strong. Put our lives back in right order, teach us to endure what is hard, humble our pride, and make us quick to serve. Help us use every bit of strength You have given us for the good of the people You have entrusted to us. Amen.



ROOTED IN THE WORD

PSALM 1:1-3

- 1** Blessed is the one who does not walk in step with the wicked or stand in the way that sinners take or sit in the company of mockers,
- 2** but whose delights is in the law of the Lord, and who meditates on his law day and night.
- 3** That person is like a tree planted by streams of water, which yields its fruit in season and whose leaf does not wither – whatever they do prospers

NIV



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